Halberstadt CL.II

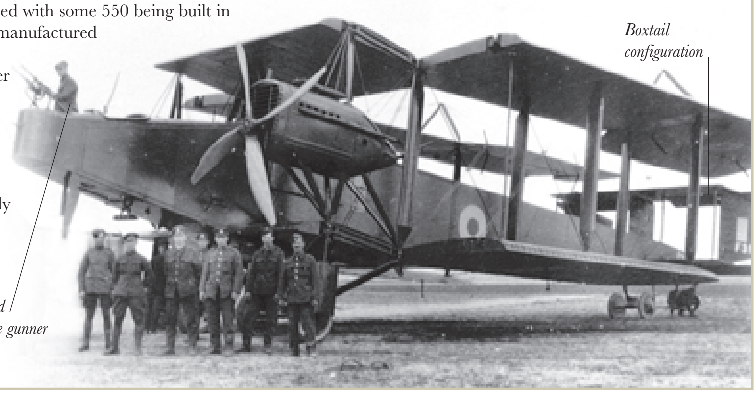
Although designed as an escort fighter, the CL.II was first used for close support in September 1917, when 24 aircraft attacked a British division. By the beginning of 1918, the CL.II was joined by the improved CL.IV. Their use in close support of the German infantry during allied counterattacks was frequently crucial.

Engine	160hp Mercedes D III 6-cylinder water-cooled inline		
Wingspan	35ft 4in (10.8m)	**Length**	23ft 11in (7.3m)
Top speed	103mph (165kph)	**Crew**	2
Armament	2 x fixed and 1 x movable machine guns; 110lb (50kg) anti-personnel grenades or 22lb (10kg) bombload		

Handley Page 0/400

In comparison with Russia and Italy, Britain was slow to build a heavy bomber. A requirement for a "bloody paralyzer of an airplane" was eventually met by the HP O/100, which entered service in November 1916. This led to the much more numerous O/400. Very large orders were placed with some 550 being built in Britain and over 100 manufactured in the US. The type began as a day bomber on the Western Front in April 1917 and continued in RAF service, as a transport, until 1920. Four were subsequently converted to civil airliners for overseas route-proving.

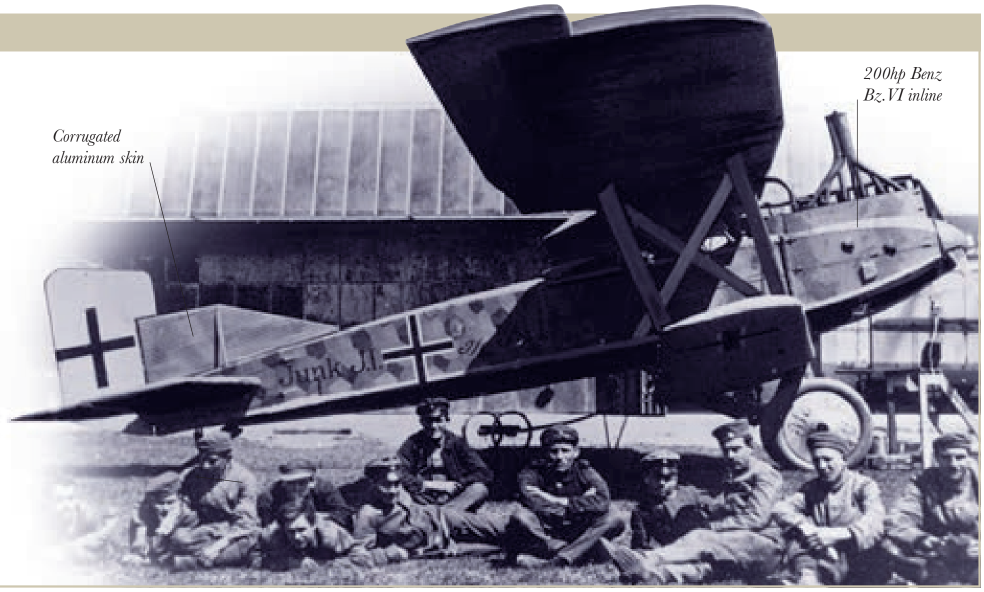
Engine	2 x 360hp Rolls-Royce Eagle VIII water-cooled V-12		
Wingspan	100ft (30.5m)	**Length**	62ft 10in (19.2m)
Top speed	97mph (156kph)	**Crew**	4
Armament	5 x .303in machine guns; 2,000lb (907kg) bombload		



Junkers J 4 (J.I)

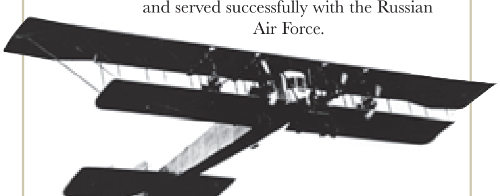
When Dr. Hugo Junkers built his first airplane, the J 1, in 1915, it appeared as a remarkable, pioneering, all-metal monoplane skinned with thin sheet iron. The success of this advanced design and its successor the J 2, led to an order for an armored biplane specifically for low-level reconnaissance and close support of the army. The result was the J.I, built under the factory identity of J 4, which retained the all-metal construction but was skinned with a corrugated aluminum alloy, a manufacturing technique that continued with the WWII Ju 52. An ash tailskid was the only wooden component. The first angular J.I reached the squadrons in France toward the end of 1917. Although somewhat cumbersome and tricky to handle on the ground, the new Junkers were immediately popular for their strength and armor protection. A total of 227 J.Is were built and nearly 190 served on the Western Front.

Engine	200hp Benz Bz.IV 6-cylinder inline		
Wingspan	52ft 6in (16m)	**Length**	29ft 10in (9.1m)
Top speed	97mph (155kph)	**Crew**	2
Armament	2 x fixed and 1 x movable machine guns		



Sikorsky Il'ya Muromets S-23 V

The Il'ya Muromets series of giant biplanes were developed from the world's first four-engined aircraft, *Le Grand*, which first flew in May 1913. During the war, nearly 80 were produced, in a number of variants, and served successfully with the Russian Air Force.



Engine	4 x 150hp Sunbeam V8 water-cooled inline		
Wingspan	97ft 9in (29.8m)	**Length**	56ft 1in (17.1m)
Top speed	75mph (121kph)	**Crew**	4–7
Armament	7 x machine guns; 1,150lb (522kg) bombload		

Zeppelin Staaken R.VI

The most remarkable aircraft built by the Germans during WWI were the "R" (Riesenflugzeug) type giant airplanes with four, five, or six engines. Of all the heavy bombers, those designed by Zeppelin at their Straaken works were the most remarkable. While not the largest, the R.VI was the only version to be produced in reasonable numbers. The first attack on England was on September 17, 1917, introducing the British public to an even more psychologically terrifying weapon than the Gotha.

Engine	4 x 260hp Mercedes D.IVa 6-cylinder inline		
Wingspan	138ft 6in (42.2m)	**Length**	72ft 6in (22.1m)
Top speed	84mph (135kph)	**Crew**	7
Armament	4–7 x Parabellum machine guns in nose, dorsal, and ventral positions; 4,409lb (2,000kg) bombload